

6 > Strengthen your digital security

Who's more at risk? Individuals vs Businesses

While businesses often face large-scale attacks aimed at stealing vast amounts of data or disrupting operations, individuals are equally at risk. Personal devices can be gateways for hackers to access larger networks or steal sensitive information like banking details. Both groups must prioritise cybersecurity to mitigate risks.

Importance of staying vigilant in 2025

As technology advances, so do the tactics of cybercriminals. Staying vigilant in 2025 means continuously updating your knowledge of cyber threats and adapting your security measures accordingly. Regularly reviewing and enhancing your cybersecurity practices is essential to safeguard against emerging threats.

VPNs, firewalls and antivirus software

Go beyond the jargon and master some key cybersecurity concepts in 2025. Understanding fundamental cybersecurity tools can significantly enhance your digital safety.



■ Firewalls: What do they do and how to configure one?

Firewalls act as a barrier between your computer or network and the internet, monitoring incoming and outgoing traffic to block suspicious activity. They prevent unauthorised access to your system. To configure a firewall, access your device's security settings or use dedicated firewall software. Set rules to allow trusted programs while blocking unrecognised or potentially harmful ones.

■ VPNs: Their benefits and when to use

Virtual Private Networks (VPNs) create a secure, encrypted connection over the internet, masking your IP address and location. This is particularly beneficial when using public Wi-Fi networks, as it protects your data from potential eavesdroppers. Use a VPN when accessing sensitive information remotely or when you want to maintain privacy online.

■ Antivirus and malware protection essentials

Anti-virus software detects and removes malicious software from your devices. Essential practices include installing reputable anti-

virus programs, keeping them updated, and running regular system scans. Real-time protection features can prevent threats before they cause harm.

How to practise cyber hygiene daily

Maintaining good cyber hygiene is crucial for ongoing security. Just like an apple a day can keep the doctor away, staying cyber vigilant everyday is key to digital security in 2025.

■ Regular software updates and patch management

Software updates often include patches for security vulnerabilities. Regularly updating your operating system and applications ensures you have the latest protections. Enable automatic updates where possible to streamline this process.

■ How to secure Wi-Fi for home and public networks

At home, secure your Wi-Fi by changing default router passwords and using strong encryption like WPA3. When using public Wi-Fi, avoid accessing sensitive data or use a VPN to encrypt your connection and protect against potential threats.

■ Don't forget to log out

Always log out of accounts on shared or public devices. Failing to do so can leave your personal information accessible to others. Additionally, consider clearing the browser history and cache after use to remove traces of your activity.

2) Of stronger passwords and MFAs

Strong, unique passwords are critical

There's no way of overstating this: Passwords are your first line of defence against unauthorised access, and making them as complicated to guess as possible is worth it. When it comes to choosing your password, always remember that convenience is your enemy.

What makes a password secure?

A secure password is at least 12 characters long and includes a mix of uppercase and lowercase letters, numbers, and special symbols. Avoid using easily guessable information like birthdays or common words.

Avoiding common mistakes

Never reuse passwords across multiple accounts. If one account is compromised, others become vulnerable. Avoid simple passwords like "password123" or "qwerty," which are easily cracked by hackers using automated tools.

How to generate complex passwords?

Use password generators to create complex, random passwords. Many password managers offer built-in generators, or you can use reputable online tools to create strong passwords that are hard to guess.